

Interviewer: Ayan okay the recording has started, and again good evening [Participant's Name] and thank you so much for participating in this research project. Now to start with, we'll have a few questions about your demographics. [Participant's Name], how old are you?

Speaker: I'm [21-25] years old po, born on [Date].

Interviewer: Okay, [21-25] years old. Now how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker: We've been together for [1-5] years na po. And actually we dated for [1-5] year and then after a year we became officially partners. And then nag celebrate kami the [inaudible] [1st-5th] year on [Month] last year.

Interviewer: [Month] last year, okay so um approaching [6-10] years na this year.

Speaker: Yes, yes that's right.

Interviewer: I see. Now do you currently have any children?

Speaker: Insurance uhm, we started our insurance.

Interviewer: Children, sorry.

Speaker: Uh, sorry. Akala ko insurance. Sorry. Children. Okay.

Interviewer: Do you currently have any children?

Speaker: No children po.

Interviewer: No children. Okay. Now who lives in the household? Are you living together or separately?

Speaker: In our current setup, siguro mga um it's been [1-5] years na po. Her aunt and her brother and two of her cousins are renting here in [City A]. Um, and then she decided to join them when she started to work here in [City A]. And then since it's a rented house and there's an extra room in their rented house, they asked me if I can move in with them so that I can be with her most of the time. Yeah but we are living in separate rooms but same house.

Interviewer: Ah okay, separate rooms but same house. Okay. So, started to work in [City A]. Saan ba siya galing? Or hindi ba siya taga [City A] or ano lang—

Speaker: Um we're from [City B] po eh.

Interviewer: Ah okay I see.

Speaker: And we both studied sa [University] so doon kami nagkakilala sa [City C].

Interviewer: Hmm okay okay.

Speaker: Then we worked here in [City A].

Interviewer: I see, I see. Now, can I also ask about your main source of income or your current job as well?

Speaker: My current source of income is my employment. I'm currently holding the position of a [occupation] palang po sa isang [Company] to be precise. And located po sa [Location].

Interviewer: I see, I see. Now, how would you like us to address your partner throughout the interview? Would you like to call her by name lang or?

Speaker: You can call her by name. [Partner's Name]. [gibberish].

Interviewer: Okay sig. Now, napahapyawan na yung love story niyo but can you tell me more about it?

Speaker: Okay, our love story. Okay, let me start by narrating how we both met. So, um during our time in the university around [Year], she joined our organization. If you're familiar with [Organization]. So, are you familiar with [Organization]?

Interviewer: Oo parang narinig ko na.

Speaker: It's a [organization] [gibberish]. The one with [description].

Speaker: So, um she joined our organization on [Year] noh. And during that time, I was the [position]. So, nag join siya she joined the orye. And then I entertained her. But during that time, she was with her friend and her boyfriend, ex boyfriend.

Interviewer: Oh, okay okay.

Speaker: So, actually during that time, hindi ko pa, hindi ko pa siya namukhaan eh. Hindi ko siya namukhaan masiyado so uh pinag register ko lang ganyan ganyan, meet meet, orientation. And then on our first anniversary ng organization, first anniversary niya sa organization.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Since she joined, doon siya, doon ko siya mas nakilala kasi may mga activities and all. So pumunta kami sa [Location] along with our org mates were around 20 people. So may mga activities na naganap sa [Location] so doon kami nagkakilala masiyado. Pero um, just a premise lang po um hindi siya naging active sa org na yon.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: That's why hindi ko siya nakilala or hindi kami naging close . So, nung anniversary lang doon lang siya lumitaw ulit.

Interviewer: Uh-huh, okay.

Speaker: So doon po kami nagkakilala. And then tinanong ko kung sino siya kasi parang nagandahan ako sa kanya nung time na iyon. Yeah so, in-introduce siya sa akin "Hi her name is [Partner's Name] [inaudible], his name is [Participant's Name]" ganyan.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: And then yeah so, nagpaka active na siya. After kasi ng [Location] uh right after [Location] kinabukasan we went to [Location] so yeah my um we went to the river, yung sikat na river and then naligo kami. And we ano po, we partied din so mga ano yon group of 10 na so mas naging close yung conversation. Eventually naging friends kami um ng ilang months. And then after [1-5] months ata naging officer din siya. So, she was elected so mas naging close kami. Kasi mas umonti diba yung circles. Tapos pag may mga meetings lagi kami magkasama and then hindi ko pa siya type na type noon. Parang

nagandahan lang ako nung anniversary. So um, pero I like her company so wala akong girlfriend noong time na yon. And wala na rin siyang boyfriend noong time na yon kasi nagbreak sila after, before the anniversary the one with [Location] single na siya noong time na iyon. Pero hindi po kami nag ano, no flirting noong time na iyon, friends lang. Tapos and ano ba, mas naging develop kasi tine-tease na kami ng mga tao like “Uy kayo na ba?” “bakit hindi pa maging kayo eh lagi kayong magkasama” ganyan.

Interviewer: Uh-huh,

Speaker: Okay, and then, and then siya din yung naging adviser ko din doon sa nililigawan ko noong time na iyon. Kasi oo, mayroon po ako naging ka-M.U. noong time na iyon so humingi ako ng advice habang kumakain kami. “Uy ano gagawin ko sa ganyan?” parang ganito response niya ganito irereply. So fast forward, mga after 3 months ulit. 3-4 months ata being close friends um, uh I did the first move. Sinundo ko siya sa bahay may party ulit doon sa [City C]. So sinundo ko po siya sa bahay niya and then we went together doon sa party na iyon. And then um, eventually tinanong ko na siya kung pwede ko ba siya maging girlfriend and she said yes. I mean sorry, before ko siya tanungin na maging girlfriend um nagkagusto pala siya sakin first.

Interviewer: Ah okay.

Speaker: But hindi ko nagustuhan yung ah yung pagiging malungkot niya pag hindi niya ako nakikita. So sinabi niya doon sa common friends namin na gusto niya ako pero mukha daw akong malandi lang.

Interviewer: [Laughing]

Speaker: Oo. Mukha lang daw ako malandi.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Tapos pumupunta daw siya doon sa party na yon lately ko lang nalaman. On our second anniversary, doon ko nalaman na sumasama pala siya because of me.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: Oo so, tapos pag hindi um hindi daw ako sumasama nalulungkot siya. Eh ayaw ko ng ganon, ayaw ko ng may nalulungkot because of me per se, my absence. So sabi ko “no, ganiyan ganiyan” so hindi kami hindi ko siya in-entertain. And then she went to [Country] uh and then namiss ko siya so—

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: So parang “ah type ko na tong babae na ito” sabi ko. And then after a month niligawan ko na po siya.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: So ayon naging mag boyfriend-girlfriend kami. After ano [1-5] year of dating, fast forward after [1-5] year. Um tama ba, oo, [1-5] year po nag de-date tapos ayun na tinanong ko na siya kung pwede ko ba siya maging girlfriend. Okay and then, nag de-date lang po kami lagi sa [City C]. Lagi kami magkasama, official na pag nakikita kami ng mga tao na hindi na kami friends. Mag boyfriend-girlfriend na kami. And then, actually on an hour last second [inaudible]. After one year of being boyfriend-girlfriend nag move-in kami together sa isang apartment sa [City C]. Nag move-in kami together kasama mga friends namin.

Isang malaki po siyang bahay pero magkasama kami sa room tas kasama namin mga friends namin. Okay so yeah, so ayun po yung um kasi naisipan namin noong time na iyon mas tipid.

Interviewer: Yeah, true.

Speaker: Tapos ano po eh, parang ang layo kasi ng bahay niya. As a boyfriend, parang hinahatid ko siya sa gabi. Kasi gabi na kami natatapos sa activities namin. Sinusundo ko rin sa umaga para less hassle mag move-in nalang kami together. Pero [inaudible] to be clear it's a mutual decision naman [inaudible].

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: And then after [1-5] year, nag graduate ako. Nauna pa ako nag graduate sa kanya. Kasi nag transfer lang siya sa [University]. She's from [University] dito sa [City A].

Interviewer: I see.

Speaker: So nag aral ako ng isang taon, I mean nagtrabaho ako ng isang sem dito sa [City A]. One sem equivalent to her stay sa [University], one sem siyang nadelay. She was studying for one sem, tapos ako nagwowork na. And then pagdating namin dito sa [City A]. Hindi pa ako, hindi ko pa sila kasama. Kasi kasama ko pa yung tito ko dito sa [City A]. Yung tinuluyan ko noong bagong salta palang po ako dito.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: Okay and then eventually nag work na rin siya dito so on the, after pandemic yun po naglipat na po ako sa kanila. And then yeah, we love traveling after pandemic. Actually noong college din po kami nagtatravel din kami.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: And then mas marami kaming travel time ngayon. So magkasama kami pumapasok, magkasama kami umuuwi tapo- yeah. Ayun po yung love story namin.

Interviewer: Okay, kasama mo ba siya right now or hindi naman?

Speaker: Hindi ko po siya kasama ngayon.

Interviewer: Okay, okay sige [laughing].

Speaker: Actually itatanong ko din po iyan, kasi nakita ko sa email. Akala ko joint kami, separate pala.

Interviewer: Yes, oo, separate yung interview.

Speaker: I assume just for you to get different opinions.

Interviewer: Oo, oo, okay.

Interviewer: Now it's already 6:40 would you like to take the break muna or?

Speaker: Traffic pa po eh.

Interviewer: Ah, traffic pa okay sige just let me know inform me lang.

Speaker: We can continue po.

Interviewer: Okay sige. That's a cute love story, it's an interesting one.

Speaker: Hindi ko po sure kung malinaw yung pagkaka narrate ko pero—

Interviewer: Oh sige, pwede natin i-review, yeah, pwede natin i-review later. [Gibberish] Just let me know kung may na-missed akong ano info. Hhmm, okay so for sure, you also have friends who are in a relationship right now? So, moving to the next question. How would you compare the quality of your relationship with [Partner's Name]? Compared to that of your friends' relationships.

Speaker: Actually ano pa eh, malaking issue yung last year kasi last year, year of breakups eh.

Interviewer: True.

Speaker: Marami kaming friends na nag break, like sobrang tagal na and then nag break. So akala namin perfect relationship, magbe-break din pala sila. Parang ah, kung paano ko macompare yung quality, quality po ba ma'am?

Interviewer: Quality, yes.

Speaker: Quality ng relationship namin, ay yung mga friends ko rin po kasi parang ano din eh. Showy din sila sa relationship nila, parang lagi rin nasa Instagram ganyan Facebook. Pero yung quality ng relationship namin [background noise] para po kaming ano partner na partner na.

Interviewer: Hhmm.

Speaker: Compared sa iba, sa iba po kasi parang may restrictions pa rin sila. Hindi pa rin sila living together. Or if they live together, siguro hindi alam ng parents or ng magulang. In our case, alam na po nila kasi. Tapos, in what aspects po ba yung qualities. Do you want to specify po kung paano?

Interviewer: Umm, I'd like to throw back the question to you because ayon yun yung gusto namin malaman din on how you define or conceptualize relationship quality. And we're interested on how you understand it to be. So ayon [inaudible], answer the question back to you. It depends on how you receive a relationship calling [inaudible].

Speaker: Okay sige, I define a quality relationship po kapag um you guys face the battle together and leaving no one behind. Parang ganon, um parang um, magkasama kayo through ups and downs. And then hindi kayo nagpapatnag sa problem, I think that's the parang a quality relationship na nasabi ko. And then, sorry wait lang po ah. Quality ng relationship namin, people see us parang as ideal couple

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: Parang pag nakikita nila kami parang we're perfect ganyan hindi nag-aaway, walang problema sa buhay. And then parang extravagant parang ganon. Pero inside our house, we have conflicts din like who's gonna be doing the laundry.

Interviewer: Hhmm.

Speaker: Who's gonna sweep the floor parang ganon. Yeah, we do, we do have conflicts nag-aaway po kami. Pero dinadaan din po namin sa agreement like for example, if we get married ganyan. Kailangan namin mag work hard para ma-afford namin yung parang kasambahay po. Kasi nalaman namin na karaniwan sa mga quarrels ng newly weds um hindi pa kasi nila nakilala yung isa't isa. Hindi sila nag live-

in together so nagulat sila sa mga problems of ano living together. Sino maglalaba ganyan, so yun po yung naging uh, um, way namin para ma-address yung ganon. And then actually, there's one thing lang that um sa tingin ko hindi, hindi kami qualified to be called a quality relationship. Kasi we do fight, pagdating sa finances which is I think common naman especially if magkasama na kayo. And I think married couples do fight about their finances. Pero that's what we limit, kasi hindi kami nag-aaway sa finances. In a way na "uy ganyan malaki yung sinasahod mo, ako ganyan lang." [Inaudible] No, we fight about our individual finances kasi hindi po kami parang hindi pa kami natututo maging serious financially. So one, is advocating about financial planning ganyan pero pag may idea yung isa, one is supportive naman so parang ganon.

Speaker: Okay let me put it in specific context, for example ako, I want us to save ganyan and then she wants to travel kasi daw parang uh yolo – you only live once and money can come back anytime. It can be earned, pero ako naman as a supportive boyfriend, sure why not parang ganon. Yun lang po yung answer ko doon pero this year um [gibberish] parang pinipilit na po namin sarili namin maging financially aware para hindi na masayang yung mga dapat na na-save namin. Same as her din, for example, gusto niya rin akong mag-save ganyan pero kapag may idea akong ganyan investment or something tapos biglang magfe-fail parang sayang sabi niya parang ganon. So yeah, yun lang po yung mga conflict na pinag-awayan namin hindi naman siya yung finances um na gaya po nung sinabi ko na mas malaki yung ganyan dapat hindi ka gumagastos ng ganito or something. Okay so, I think ayun po yung mga bad qualities namin pero marami naman po kaming good qualities. I think it's a matter of focusing on the good and the bad and that will make even more qualified to be called quality relationship knowing the bad quality and the good quality. Umm, for the good quality naman. Um since nasabi ko yung bad. Yeah, we are supportive to each other tapos we want the company of each other. When we plan, lagi po namin sinasama yung isa't isa so yun po.

Interviewer: Okay, okay sige, so in general, if icompare mo yung relationship ng friends mo sa relationship niyo? What would, what would be your point of comparison or um having this in mind, having itong qualities you mentioned in mind. So siguro what sets your relationship apart from them if you'd compare?

Speaker: Okay um, if I'm gonna compare our relationship with other relationships po.

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: Sa ibang relationships kasi nakikita ko parang may dominant na tao.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: Oo. Tapos yung dominant na iyan, yung laging parang masusunod or nasusunod siya yung nagdi-direct ng path ng both of you. Pero sa amin po kasi, pareho po kaming dominant. Parang oo, kami naglelead sa relationship namin na nagca-cause ng ano mga nasabi ko kanina bad traits. So yun po yung may, yung trait na point of comparison sa iba.

Interviewer: I see. Now, Can I also ask, did you have any romantic partners in the past before [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: Um romantic partners, meron po akong ano isang naging ex. Pero highschool pa po iyon eh parang hindi siya ex na officially. Pero the bond was good naman strong naman nung time na iyon.

Interviewer: Oki, uh-huh. Now, siguro kahit hindi siya official or ayon. How would you compare the quality of your relationship with [Partner's Name] sa previous ano mo, previous romantic partner?

Speaker: Same with uh point of comparison that I pointed out kanina. Sa relationship namin, noong naka M.U. ko before ako po yung dominant, ako yung naglead ng relationship namin. And ayon nakakagulat lang ngayon, that meron akong kasama na.

Interviewer: Uh-uh I see, now, [inaudible] forward for you. We're talking about quality na this time noh. What makes a relationship high quality?

Speaker: Ohh, as I've mentioned din po kanina what can define or describe a quality relationship is when you both faced every problems together and leaving no one behind. Kumbaga when you plan you are always thinking of your partner. Tapos dapat, kasi may nabasa po ako na parang relationship or romantic relationship is not a battle it's a war. Dapat hindi lang natatapos sa isang battle, mahabang war po siya na dapat pareho niyong lagpasan or harapin na hindi kayo nasisira.

Interviewer: I see, how about—

Speaker: Just to add ma'am yung kanina noh, dapat hindi rin kayo, hindi niyo pinapatagal siguro yung away and hindi dapat nag-iwan ng lamat sa relationship niyo. Tas dapat hindi kayo nag-aaway on finances or something.

Interviewer: Now, doon naman tayo sa opposite. What makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: I think kapag petty things pinag-aawayan niyo, yung away na hindi ka-proud proud na sasabihin ng ibang tao kapag nakwento niyo, “ dahil lang doon nag-away kayo? dahil lang doon?” parang ganon. Tapos magiging low quality siya kapag nagpapadala kayo sa opinion ng other people. You know when you have friends di'ba? Wala silang binibigay na benefit of the doubt.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: If you're, if you're their friend noh they're gonna support you always without pointing out the bad in you. That's what I mean, na hindi po kayo [background noise] dapat nagpapadala sa opinyon ng ibang tao kasi pag nagbigay ng opinyon ang isang tao it's either it's most of the time na papanig sila sayo. Which is ibo-boost nila yung side mo, without even you realize or think kung tama ka ba or mali ka talaga.

Interviewer: I see, now, moving forward for you ba what are the most important thing in a relationship?

Speaker: Hmm, for me po what's the most important thing in the relationship is I think understanding, cooperation. Tapos..hindi, understanding and teamwork kasi um sabi nila communication is the key daw. It's not communication, but it's understanding kasi kahit na nag cocommunicate kayo kung hindi mo naman siya hindi mo naman naco-comprehend or hindi mo naiintindihan masiyado. It's gonna be useless, tapos teamwork, as I've said it's a long war so dapat teamwork kayo always.

Interviewer: Hmm, I see. Now, proceed to the next question, ito medyo slambook, slambook yung question. But for you, what is love?

Speaker: Uh [laughing] mayroon akong nasa isip eh kaso scientific siya joke lang nabasa, napanood ko lang somewhere. Can I share it? Parang—

Interviewer: Sure.

Speaker: Parang they say love is nothing but a series of chemical chain reaction inside the brain [gibberish]. Pero para sa akin po love is um dapat ano siya unconditional um pag sinabing unconditional dapat, ano ba parang for example, dapat ipapareha mo siya kung gaano ka minahal ng mother mo. Kasi parang yun yung purest definition of unconditional yung gagawin lahat para lang sayo. And then, di naman siya lahat baka kasi ibash ako ng mga tao when I say lahat. Di'ba? we live in a modern society na dapat magtira ka sa sarili mo pero for me ah, when you define love dapat unconditional siya. Dapat hindi ka humihingi ng kapalit, and ginagawa mo dapat yon dahil hindi siya social construct pero ayon yung sinasabi ng damdamin mo. Na sasamahan ko itong tao na ito hanggang sa pagtanda niya, and then um, kailangan nandiyon ako sa tabi niya no matter what kasi mahal ko siya parang ganon.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: Tapos kung hindi ko man kaya ibigay kung ano yung deserve niya pero, di ko man kaya ibigay yung deserve niya pero gagawin ko naman ang lahat. Ah with all my might para maparamdam sa kanya na deserve niya ng ganitong pagmamahal. Pero you cross mountains para sa kanya, parang ganon that's unconditioned.

Interviewer: Hhmm. Now, your definition of love is very solid. But how important for you love in a relationship?

Speaker: Relationship without love is parang robotic eh, parang if you've watch big bang theory. Have you watched big bang theory po?

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: Si sheldon po tapos, ano pangalan non wait lang I forgot the name of ano her partner.

Interviewer: Yung partner niya. Oo. Oo. Nasa dulo ng dila ko rin.

Speaker: Pero yeah si sheldon tapos yun, may love may love noh pero kay sheldon yung purpose niya lang for science, appropriation parang ganyan. Sorry na-lost po ako sa tanong niyo uh

Interviewer: How important is love?

Speaker: How important is love kasi nga pag walang love relationship it's robotic. Love kasi it's like if you're gonna um compare it to a cruise ship siya yung parang rotor. Yung [inaudible] umiikot po sa likod parang elesi parang ganon. It's gonna be a rotor so pag may love um you can keep the relationship forward or moving kasi without it it's gonna be um boring or stagnant ganon po.

Interviewer: Uh-huh, I see. Now, how do you know your partner loves you? or how do you know that [Partner's Name] loves you?

Speaker: Yeah, because I can feel it naman na she loves me because she wants me to be by her side. She wants to see me, she includes me in her plans, she wants to grow old with me.

Interviewer: That's great. Now, moving on. Would you say that the relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Relationship is good for me, yeah it's good for me we can make it better or best. Yeah, it's gonna be better. As I've said earlier noh you cannot say a perfect relationship. There's always a conflict and what's important is that you learn from the conflict and then be better next time. So in terms of our relationship is that, we are not in the optimum level of quality relationship because marami pa po kami

kailangan matutunan [background noise] o natututunan or nae-experience. Pero for your question, is it a good relationship. Yes it is definitely a good relationship.

Interviewer: Now, how do you say so? Can you provide specific example? Paano mo nafeel na this relationship is good for me?

Speaker: This relationship is good for me because um, wala po eh parang I see her parang I see her as my ano eh as my lifeline [gibberish] lifeline ba english nun? Parang yung shoulder to lean on—

Interviewer: Oo. Uh-huh.

Speaker: As my, as my buddy, as a buddy na you guys moving towards the same direction. While you traverse the direction no, parang you guys are happy that you have each other.

Interviewer: Okay, now nabanggit mo before um when we're talking about quality and ngayon just recently when we're talking about whether the relationship is good for you. You're talking about um conflict in the relationship and you mentioned na ayon one conflict would be your finances. Mayroon din kayo pinag-aawayn like quarrels about chores in the house. But ayon doon tayo mag expound for this moment. What would you say are challenges in your relationship so pwedeng challenges before, challenges you are facing right now, or challenges in the future.

Speaker: Okay, I think the challenges now the chores and the finances that I've said earlier. I think challenges in the future I think it's more on a building—ah alam ko na. Parang it's hard for us to be away from each other po kasi and I think it's gonna be a challenge na that we parang leave separately and grow temporarily on our own. Yeah, iyon po yung parang challenge na nakikita kong mahirap para sa amin future. Now, another thing sa pag build po ng career namin kasi may mga plans po kaming this year like living abroad, going somewhere as a student, and then start over as a student as part-time lang then eventually uh gaining citizenship. So sabihin ko na po noh.

Interviewer: Uh-uh.

Speaker: Sa [Country] po kasi nagpa-plan po kami to go there so currently we are processing our requirements. So isa po iyon sa mga challenges na sa tingin ko kakaharapin namin kasi hindi po namin alam the future lies ahead. It's gonna be difficult and we have no clue po ano mangyayari because a lot of things can happen in a year or two.

Interviewer: Uh-uh, okay. When did you plan to go to [Country] ba? Would it be this year? Or next year pa or—

Speaker: This year, this year po ma'am.

Interviewer: Ah this year, I see.

Speaker: Target [Month] po.

Speaker: Yeah late this year, I see. Now, moving forward, so ayan yung mga chores, finances, future challenges. Just for the interview guide. But do you and your partner fight?

Speaker: Ah do we fight?

Interviewer: Oo, oo.

Speaker: Yeah, yeah we do fight. Siguro um, in a week siguro once a week lang parang ganon, misunderstanding lang not fight-fight.

Interviewer: Now, how do you resolve this fight? Nabanggit mo before na you talk about and you learn um from what you have experience?

Speaker: Sorry Ma'am, can I get you for a while?

Interviewer: Okay, sige sige.

Speaker: Let us reserve that question take a break lang po saglit.

Interviewer: Oh sige sige. No problem.

Speaker: Thank you, thank you.

Interviewer: Sure sure.

Speaker: Uh can I make it 10 minutes?

Interviewer: 10 minutes okay no problem.

Speaker: Thank you Ma'am.

[Long pause]

Speaker: Hi Ma'am.

Interviewer: Hi. Settled na? All settled na?

Speaker: Yeah oo. Actually nandito pa ako sa restaurant okay lang po ba? pero it's peaceful naman.

Interviewer: Okay sure.

Speaker: I'm just gonna eat lang po.

Interviewer: Okay sige, would you like to eat first?

Speaker: No, it's okay I mean pica pica lang naman po.

Interviewer: Ah okay sige sige.

Speaker: Uh don't worry about it po okay lang ako.

Interviewer: Okay sige sige. Now, all settled na can we proceed back to the interview?

Speaker: Yes we can proceed po.

Interviewer: Okay sige. So, we we're talking about conflict and yun nga yung pag-aaway niyo if you and you're partner fight nandun na tayo sa question about how do you resolve these fights? So you mentioned na you talk about it and then you learn to be better or yeah pero would you like to expound on how you resolve your fights or misunderstandings.

Speaker: Um, learning about the lesson every fight is one thing pero another thing po is dapat you have. You must learn to you know uh keep your mouth shut if you're one way. Because you might say words

that might hurt the other person. So if I'm angry I don't talk much I mean if it's I'm too angry naman. I don't talk because I might be harsh and that might leave a scar to my partner so yun po yung aside from that, we should learn from the experiences of other people. As much as I don't want to um, be told na parang sila yun eh uh parang you're different. Hindi mo dapat icompare yung relationship mo with other people pero uh kasi you must learn from other people without experiencing it [inaudible] and maiwasan mo na in the future. If yun yung naging conflict nila and that's how they address it edi pwede mo siyang iconsider as factor din. Para hindi lumala, or get advice from them, especially books ganyan and life coaches. [Background noise] I listen to podcast din po.

Interviewer: I see. Just to clarify, you resolved the fight by talking it out and then ayon keeping your mouth shut and learning from the experiences of other people, do I get that right?

Speaker: Yes, Ma'am.

Interviewer: Now aside from that, what other ways that you do, ikaw or si partner or what you both do to maintain it, sa maintenance naman tayo ng relationship, pagme-maintain ng relationship—

Speaker: When it comes to maintenance noh I mean to. Sorry you're asking about—

Interviewer: Oo.

Speaker: On how to maintain.

Interviewer: What do you do to maintain, oo, what do you do to maintain the relationship?

Speaker: Siguro po ano, parang aside from learning the lessons from past conflicts para hindi na maiwasan. Siguro you have to entice each other from time to time hindi porket kasi na matagal na kayo there's gonna be no ano na no spice. [Background noise] When I say spice the good moments, dapat from time to time you give her gifts, you appreciate her. Tapos you asked her for dates, compliments, hugs parang ganon ayun po that's another that's one thing. Tas isa pa how to maintain a relationship, ako po kasi ang love language ko kasi parang ano eh physical touch gusto ko lagi kasama siya so para sa akin mas mamaintain [background noise] ang relationship pag magkasama kayo together.

Interviewer: Uh-huh.

Speaker: Kasi masasabayan yung ginagalaw pang araw-araw. Tapos how to maintain the relationship siguro keeping as what I've said earlier love is the rotor [background noise] of a relationship so there must be love. Ang kakambal kasi ng love [background noise] is um, siguro ano bang tamang english dun care? Pag aaruga.

Interviewer: Care, hmmm.

Speaker: Pag-aaruga tapos trust them, if you love someone dapat inaalagaan mo siya not na aalagaan na parang baby pero aalagaan lang. And then dapat you trust them then, kasi it's gonna be difficult if walang trust and care sa relationship. When I say care din, parang hindi lang sarili mo naisip mo. When you eat ah you know the little things dapat you ask her kung gusto niya rin ba kumain. Yeah, so mga ganun po little things pero I think it can maintain the relationship.

Interviewer: I see, now let's talk about change, change naman. Did the relationship change you and in what way?

Speaker: Yeah, change is inevitable for it. But I think if you will change you should change for the better. Feeling ko the relationship changed me when it comes to um being with my family more, kasi family-oriented person siya. I claimed that I'm a family-oriented person pero for her kasi a family-oriented person is lagi gusto makita or makasama o makausap. And then pagdating sa hobbies and goals din, parang before I am not thinking long-term. When it comes to uh yung pagdating po sa hindi ako na exposed sa pag think ng long-term yung living abroad. Before po I just wanna be successful dito sa Pilipinas be a contributors dito sa ating country parang ganon. When I enter the relationship parang doon ko nalalaman na parang there's more pa pala outside the country. There are other cultures na I mean maganda rin ma-exposed sa other cultures. And then another thing po, um I think sa ano ko rin sa—sa fashion sense ko rin. Before parang normal wearing guy lang po kasi ako. Yeah, people parang appreciate my looks than before they define me clean, neat ganyan. Pero when I enter the relationship parang she finds it parang baduy yang medyas na yan it's white parang ganon. It changed my fashion perspective yun lang po so far.

Interviewer: How about the other way around? How about your partner? Did they change during the relationship?

Speaker: Hhmm. I think mas na-open po ako when it comes to thinking financially about making goals in life. Parang kasi as I've mentioned po you only live once siya parang ganon without making any goals. So uh when she entered the relationship yun po ah we began to make goals and plans [inaudible].

Interviewer: I see. What else?

Speaker: Actually para sakin mahirap siya baguhin na tao kung ano siya, ano siya parang ganon. Ako parang I love going to church, praying sometimes I even ask her to go to church pero hindi ko siya naiimpluwensiyahan eh. Though I'm not a religious person pero I believe in parang praying. Pero hindi pa rin po siya nagdadasal or anything. Yeah, yun lang po.

Interviewer: Now, let's talk about safety. So do you also feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker: Yeah opo, what do you mean safety po or it's up to me?

Interviewer: Oo it's up to you din [laughing].

Speaker: Safety um pag sinabi mo kasing safety in a relationship parang safe sa pag-iisip or peace of mind.

Interviewer: Hhmm.

Speaker: Tapos pag sinabi mo kasing safety you are talking about the foundation that it is built on noh. So parang sa akin the relationship is safe, I think my partner is loyal and faithful naman sa akin. And I think my foundation is strong enough to face any typhoons that we could face.

Interviewer: Hhmm, uh-uh.

Speaker: When it comes to peace of mind, wala pa po siyang parang hindi ko pa po nafefeel yung total peace of mind kasi as I've mentioned we are still building our career and there are a lot of conflicts pa and uncertainty pa. Pero at night, when we go home together, when we eat together there's a peace of mind na thinking that I'm in my city [inaudible] parang ganon.

Interviewer: That's good to hear okay. Now, for the next question. I'll be sharing my screen for a while, ready ko lang. Ayan can you see my screen?

Speaker: Yeah, I can see your screen po.

Interviewer: Ayan, okay.

Speaker: But it says click to add title. Is it really an—

Interviewer: Oo, oo. Empty pa. Okay. Ayan how about that? Kita naman.

Speaker: Hhmm. Click to add title pa rin po.

Interviewer: Ah sige dito nalang tayo sa ano. I tried the slideshow but it doesn't work. So for the next questions, I'll be showing you two statements and then I'll be asking you to rate it. So let's proceed lang. So for the first statement, my partner usually really listens to me. On a scale of 1 as not at all true to 9 as completely true. How would you rate the agreement to the statement?

Speaker: Uh my partner usually really listens to me. I think moderately true.

Interviewer: Okay, that's a five. Okay, again before we um expound on that let's proceed to the second statement. My partner usually is responsive to my needs, so same scale din how would you rate your agreement to the statement?

Speaker: Ah very true po.

Interviewer: Very true, that's seven. Okay sige. So let's get back to the first statement you answered, moderately true of five. So why five?

Speaker: Uhm. My partner usually really listens to me. Kasi when I say something noh she doesn't believe me at first, but when she hears the topic from other people ah she begins to believe na it's—it's true pala parang ganon. For example for the topic of, I can't pinpoint specific topic. When I open up a particular topic, let's say for example, this school, I bring it up to her. Tapos "uh-huh" ganon parang ganon response niya. But when she hears it from other people parang that's uh when she begins to ano na um, um ano tawag doon uh believe na, that's when she begins to believe na its true pala parang ganon. I don't think it's really her character to ask for second opinion.

Interviewer: Uh-huh. Okay sige, why not ano why not four or why not six?

Speaker: Siguro po ano I'm playing unto [background noise] big ideas lang pero on small matters naman she believes po

Interviewer: Uh-huh I see. Now, proceeding to the next statement. My partner is responsive to my needs. You answered seven for that. That's very true. So why seven?

Speaker: Okay. Because I don't...As one time I said earlier, we are not...wala po masiyadong perfect couple. And I think kapag your partner um really gives your needs more, it's going to be a perfect relationship for me yun lang po um. Pero um yeah she gives my needs naman po.

Interviewer: She gives naman. Similar question din, why not six or why not eight in this case? why not six or eight

Speaker: Is that the lower category? Lower options?

Interviewer: Six, papunta siya sa lower. Papunta siya sa moderately true and then yung eight is pa ano completely true, eight, nine.

Speaker: For the second question, I answered completely true po ata.

Interviewer: Ah completely true, very true yon I think very true nabanggit? Is it completely true?

Speaker: Second to the highest po ata. The one I—

Interviewer: Second to the highest. So that's eight?

Speaker: Yeah, that's eight.

Interviewer: Eight. Okay sig. So thanks for clarifying. Sig so in this case, why not nine? Or—

Speaker: Yeah, that's what I've said. When it's going to be nine or ten, po it's a perfect relationship na . And there's no perfect relationship pa for me, especially in our case. So you can only give ten when you reach that point of certainty.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Adulthood certainty.

Interviewer: Okay sig. Now for the next question, and I hope you don't mind if I ask, but feel free to say if this is too sensitive for you to share or to answer. But I also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker: Okay. Every two weeks.

Interviewer: Every two weeks. Okay. And [inaudible] how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker: I'm going to rate it ten out of ten. I think ten.

Interviewer: Ten naman so satisfied naman.

Speaker: Hhmm.

Interviewer: Hhmm.

Interviewer: Okay I see. So why do you say so? Or if you would like to add more to it?

Speaker: umm, I think kasi wala naman na pong iba kasi na parang makakapag satisfy kaya I'm going toU rate it ten out of ten nalang po.

Interviewer: Okay. Now for the next question, I'll be sharing my screen once again. Is it visible?

Speaker: Opo, visible.

Interviewer: Okay. So for the next question, we're nearing the end of the interview. In general, how satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker: I think uh very satisfied.

Interviewer: Very satisfied.

Speaker: I cannot say. Later nalang po expound.

Interviewer: Okay sige. Now you answered very satisfied. So lagyan natin ng numerical number. How would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship from zero as not at all satisfied to ten as completely satisfied?

Speaker: I think eight pa din po.

Interviewer: Eight. Okay. Now going back, you answered very satisfied and then eight. Is that right?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay. So why very satisfied and why eight?

Speaker: I think um there are conflicts that govern our relationship at the moment. Especially when it comes to um making everything certain and stable. Because I've mentioned [background noise], we are somehow rearing towards starting again. And as we move to another path this year so when you say kasi na certain, it seems that you are um parang stable na that any conflict wouldn't hurt your feelings. Or one won't bring um or hurt to someone to—to his partner na makakapag correct [inaudible] ng feelings mo. [Background noise] Kasi kapag sinabi mo pong um satis— [inaudible] um certain ka na hindi ka na maiinis sa kung ano man uh ia-act ng partner mo. Kasi alam mo na at the end of the day, uh mahal ka pa din niya. And hindi niya sinasadya yung mga ginagawa niya or ganon lang talaga personality niya. Did you hear that?

Interviewer: Hmm.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. So am I still audible? Because I think I lost my net for a while, audible pa rin? [gibberish]

Speaker: Au-audible.

Interviewer: Okay. Okay. So again, thank you so much for sharing that. And we're close to wrapping up. And I would just like to summarize what we have conversed over for the past hour. So I'll be summarizing yon yung mga napag-usapan natin. And feel free to butt in if you would like to correct or add something kung mayroon pa. Okay. Now starting off with demographics, you're [21-25] years old, [1-5] years. You're already together for [1-5] years. And then no children. And then your separate rooms, living together, separate rooms pero same house. And then you're currently employed as an [occupation] sa [company]. [Company]. And then as for your love story. So [Year] was the year when you both met sa [University]. And you're a member of an organization, [Organization]. You're an officer. And then [Partner's Name], [Partner's Name] registered for, signed up, signed up for the org. And then, um noong first anniversary ni [Partner's Name] sa org, doon mo siya mas nakilala when you celebrated it at [Location], sa [Location].

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: Ah, okay. Pero hindi siya active sa org she just attended the first anniversary niya sa org and then after your short introduction, she became more active. And then mas close na yung conversation when you went to [Location] for a party with a group of 10. And then you eventually became friends. And she got elected as an officer of the organization. And then, you developed. Siya yung naging adviser mo doon sa naka M.U mo, doon sa nililigawan mo. And then [1-5] months after being close friends, you did the first move. And initially, mayroon din siyang gusto sayo pero hindi mo in-entertain because it's after

the thought na nalulungkot siya if hindi ka niya nakikita. And then she went to [Country] and you missed her. So doon mo narealized that na type mo na siya. And after [1-5] year of dating, you got officially together. And then after one year of being together, you moved in together with your friends. And then nauna kang grumaduate kasi nagtransfer lang siya from [University]. So pagdating mo ng [City A], you worked for a sum worth of her of [Partner's Name] [inaudible] in terms of time. And then eventually, you both worked together. And then after a pandemic, you moved in. Yun na yung lumipat ka sakanila.

Interviewer: And then as for relationship quality, if you were to compare the quality of your relationship to that of your friends' relationship, it was a huge issue last year. Because last year was either year of break up. So you had a lot of friends na nagbreak. And then quality relationship for you is if you face the battle together, leaving no one behind. So you're together through ups and downs and then you highlight good qualities and bad or somehow hindi good qualities in your relationship. And as for the bad qualities, people see you as ideal. People see you both as an ideal couple. But you also have conflicts, you also have quarrels. And you do fight about finances as well. But in terms of your good qualities, you're very supportive of each other and you want the company of each other. And then you have had one romantic relationship in the past pero hindi naman siya ganoon ka-official kasi high school pa siya. And if you were to compare the quality of your relationship sa previous one, you're the dominant. So nakakagulat for you at this moment because you're already together and as you mentioned, and as you've mentioned pareho kayong dominant and supporting the relationship. And high quality for you, high quality relationship for you is when you face every problem together. So relationship is not a battle, it's a war and low quality for you is when you're fighting over petty things and nagpapadala sa opinion ng ibang tao. Now the most important thing for you in a relationship, understanding and teamwork. As you have mentioned, communication is the key but it's not for you, it's understanding because if you cannot comprehend, it's useless. And teamwork because it's a long war. And conceptualization, in terms of your conceptualization of love, love for you is unconditional and you likened this love, love of a mother because it's the purest definition of unconditional for you. And love na hindi ka humihingi ng kapalit as well. Relationship without love is robotic and that's what you highlighted when I asked about the question on how important love is in a relationship and it keeps the relationship forward and moving. And you know that your partner loves you because you can feel it. So she wants you by her side, she wants to see you and she includes you in your plan. You also mentioned that the relationship is good for you because um it's not perfect. There's always a conflict but you see here as a lifeline, a shoulder to lean on and you're moving towards the same direction as well.

Interviewer: Now in terms of conflict, challenges you face at the moment are chores and finances and then your future is when you live the possibility of living separately and temporarily growing on your own as well as yung pag build ninyo ng career since you have plans of living abroad and in [Country] this year. And in terms of fights, you fight somehow once a week but more on misunderstanding sometimes. And then you resolve it by talking it out and keeping your mouth shut when you're too angry and also learning from the experiences of other people. Now aside from that, what you do to maintain the relationship is you entice each other and you maintain the relationship by sensing physical touch with it. Your love language is more rather than its physical touch. So you maintain the relationship by being together and of course there must be love and care or pag-aaruga.

Interviewer: Now in terms of change, change is inevitable and you mentioned that change, the relationship changed you in terms of your hobbies, your goals and the idea of thinking long term living abroad as well as your fashion sense. And then as for your partner, ayon change yung napansin mong

change is when it comes to thinking financially in terms of making goals in life and you also answer that you feel safe in the relationship. In terms of peace of mind and the foundation of your relationship is strong enough to face any typhoons. Although peace of mind, yung peace of mind is to be build pa kasi you're still building a future again and yung paglipat niyo din sa abroad. Now, for the two statements I showed you, you answered five for the first statement of my partner usually really listens to me because hindi mo sure kung character niya ba yung magtanong for second opinion. And you also answered eight for the second statement of your partner's responsiveness to your needs. Now, in terms of your physical intimacy, you're having sex every two weeks but generally you're satisfied and in terms of in general.

Speaker: I'm sorry, just to butt in, it's not really two weeks but it's once a week. Yeah, just to clarify thank you.

Interviewer: Ah, okay. Okay. Thanks for clarifying. So once a week, and then generally you're satisfied naman with your sex life. And then in general in the relationship you're very satisfied, you rated it as eight, you're rearing towards starting again as you move towards another path in your life but there's still conflicts, there's still challenges but overall you're willing to face it together. So did I get that right? Is there anything you'd like to add or correct?

Speaker: Ah everything is right po.

Interviewer: Okay, that's great. Now, thank you so much and before we end, I want to talk to you about how we will handle this data. Of course, as a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible and so I wanted to know which data sharing option are you most comfortable with. So mayroon tayong dalawang option. The first option is that transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you so the de-identified transcript can also be read by other researchers. Now for option number two, if you're a bit older, the whole transcript can be shared, removed of sensitive and overly identifying details so it will be anonymized. Although in this option, there is a very, very minimal chance that someone who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down who among your colleagues they believe it is. Although that would take them so much time because they didn't have to review the whole paper.

Speaker: Yeah, so the second option is find with me, po.

Interviewer: Okay, that's great. So second option. Okay, so thank you so much again for participating in this study and I would like you to know that this is also being done not only in the Philippines but also in Brazil, Turkey, France and the United States. Now for this study to be successful, there's only one last favor for you if that's okay. Can you recommend two close people in your life as a nominator? So what will happen is that the people you will provide will ask them for additional couples that might be interested in the study but will be asking them for couples that you don't know or interact with. So that way kasi mas broad yung maabot natin in terms of participants.

Speaker: You're asking for a nominator who knows a couple din po?

Interviewer: Ah, oo if possible.

Speaker: Okay, can I give you the name afterwards?

Interviewer: Sure.

Speaker: What details do you need po, email?

Interviewer: Yeah, name, email and um phone number will do.

Speaker: Okay. Phone number will do. No specific ano po noh location or background.

Interviewer: Oo wala naman. Basta makakapag-provide sila ng additional couples na pwede namin mainterview and then you can provide them a heads up so they won't block us when we contact them.

Speaker: Okay, sure. Thank you also for the opportunity. As much as I want to expand more, we only have a little time. Thank you for hearing everything. I hope this transcript would help in the study.

Interviewer: Hmm. Okay, wait, stop ko lang yung recording.